

Task: CRI D (OPVL)

Source A

Construction on Vegetated Land in Hyderabad

Hyderabad, particularly its IT corridor in the west (Gachibowli, HITEC City, Kokapet), has undergone rapid urban expansion in recent decades. A long-term study of the Hyderabad Metropolitan Region found that between 1975 and 2024, the city's built-up area increased by 188% (from 183.05 km² to 527.23 km²), while vegetation cover decreased by 59% and farmland declined by 84%. A separate satellite-based study comparing Hyderabad's IT hub areas between 2020 and 2023 recorded significant land acquisition by corporate entities and consequent tree felling in areas like Gachibowli and HITEC City, with tree cover in the study area falling by about 30.8% while built-up area rose by roughly 10.3% in just three years.

Recent example – Kancha Gachibowli forest (2025):

One of the most prominent recent cases involves a 400-acre forested patch inside the University of Hyderabad campus. In early 2025, the Telangana government's plan to auction the land for IT parks and related projects faced major resistance from students, teachers, and alumni, while Chief Minister Revanth Reddy argued the development would unlock growth and employment opportunities for the region. Satellite images later confirmed deforestation had occurred in the Kancha Gachibowli area. Campaigners described the forest as home to over 160 bird species, deer, wild boars, peacocks, and turtles, calling it one of the city's few remaining green lungs, and the matter was taken up by the Telangana High Court following petitions from environmental groups.

This case illustrates a broader tension in Hyderabad's growth: rapid construction — fuelled by IT investment and a construction boom that has made Hyderabad home to the highest number of skyscrapers and high-rise buildings in South India — is increasingly being weighed against the loss of vegetated and forested land.

Source: ThePrint — "How disputed 'forest' patch has put Hyderabad university students on the warpath against Revanth govt." ThePrint (April 2, 2025).

- 1. Give one reason why people wanted to save the Kancha Gachibowli forest, and one reason why the government wanted to build on it.**
- 2. State the Origin of the Source**
- 3. State the Purpose of the Source**